Day 39 - Walter Tovell, South Outlier Loop Trail, Carriage, Lookout, South Outlier Connector

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Dufferin Hi-Land section · hike 48 · Mono Cliffs Provincial Park

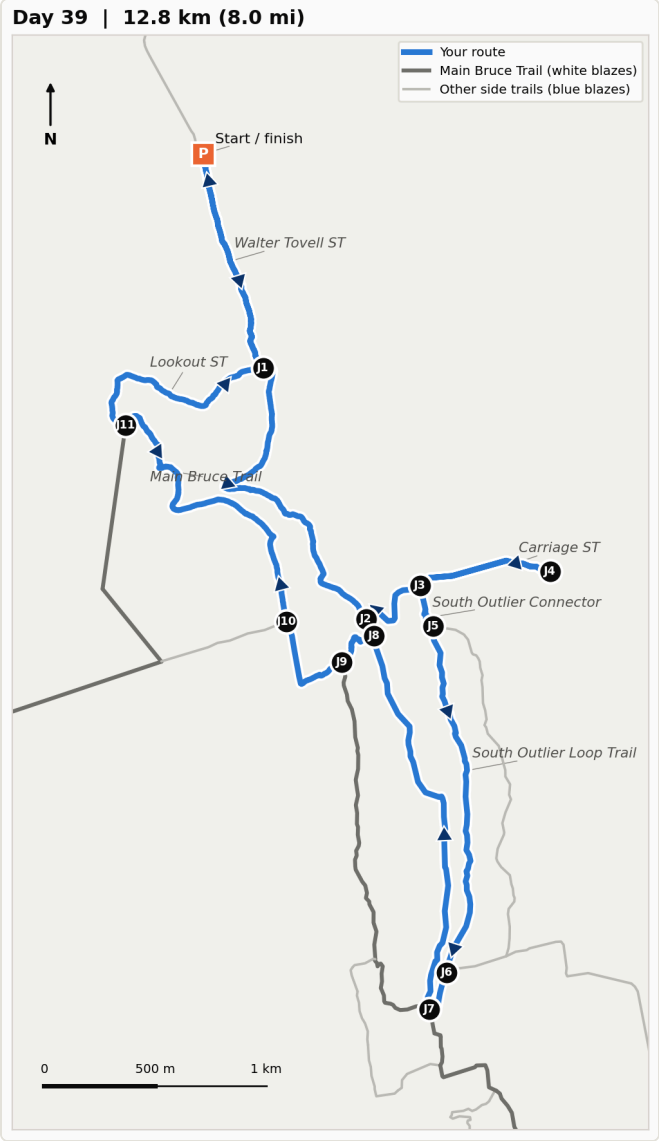
12.8 km / 8.0 mi	~3.9 h	9.1 km new	74 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Limited roadside parking on south side of 25 Sideroad where the Walter Tovell Side Trail intersects with the road. Do not block gated entrance. When no space is available, consider using the large parking area just up the road on 2nd Line EHS. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day39_hike048.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Walter Tovell Side Trail (4.7 km); South Outlier Loop Trail (1.9 km); Carriage Side Trail (1.3 km); Lookout Side Trail (1.0 km); South Outlier Connector (0.3 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** There is only limited roadside parking on the south side of 25 Sideroad at the Walter Tovell Side Trail, and you must not block the gate. If it is full, use the larger lot up the road on 2nd Line EHS. Visitor guides warn that parking elsewhere on roads around the park can get you fined or towed.
- **Walter Tovell Side Trail:** A wide, flat path, the longest trail in the park and the bulk of this hike.
- **Carriage Side Trail:** Mostly shady forest plus one large meadow. A large wooden staircase drops into the forest, and another staircase near the viewing platform leads down to the rock formations.
- **South Outlier Loop:** Begins with a climb, then runs fairly flat on top. The western side follows the cliff edge, with a lookout facing the cliffs. Keep Zappy close along the edge.
- **Lookout Side Trail:** A short spur to a lookout over the hardwood forest below.
- **Season and bugs:** Expect crowds at peak times. Bring bug spray and check for ticks. Ontario Parks notes that trails are not maintained in winter.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Limited roadside parking on south side of 25 Sideroad where the Walter Tovell Side Trail.... Head east on the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail.
1.0	0.6	J1: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Walter Tovell Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Lookout Side Trail goes off on your right.)

2.7	1.7	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Carriage Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail goes off ahead.)
3.1	2.0	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Carriage Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed South Outlier Connector goes off on your right.)
3.8	2.3	J4: End of the Carriage Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (Mono Cliffs' Ontario Parks Parking Lot: 3rd Line EHS, 900 metres north of Dufferin Rd 8). Turn around and retrace your steps.
4.4	2.7	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed South Outlier Connector, heading south. (the Carriage Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
4.6	2.9	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail goes off on your left.)
6.3	3.9	J6: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the South Outlier Loop Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail goes off on your left.)
6.5	4.0	J7: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
8.3	5.1	J8: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Walter Tovell Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Carriage Side Trail goes off on your left.)
8.4	5.2	J2: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
8.5	5.3	J8: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Carriage Side Trail, heading south-west. (the Walter Tovell Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
8.7	5.4	J9: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
8.9	5.6	Heads-up: The next 0.7 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
9.2	5.7	J10: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed McCarston's Lake Side Trail goes off on your left.)
10.8	6.7	J11: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Lookout Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
11.8	7.3	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail, heading north-west. (the Walter Tovell Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
12.8	8.0	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Parks, Ontario Hiking and Voyageur Tripper.